Cisplatin + Etoposide

Cisplatin is planned on Day 1. Etoposide is planned on Days 1–3: usually all three days by infusion, or a prescribed alternative with an infusion on Day 1 and capsules twice daily on Days 2–3. The source plans 4–6 cycles, usually every 21 days. The team may delay, reduce or stop treatment according to your health and response.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Ears / hearing

Cisplatin

Report tinnitus or hearing change promptly; discuss existing problems before starting.

2 Mouth

Etoposide

Mouth sores can affect eating or drinking. Seek advice early.

3 Chest / breathing

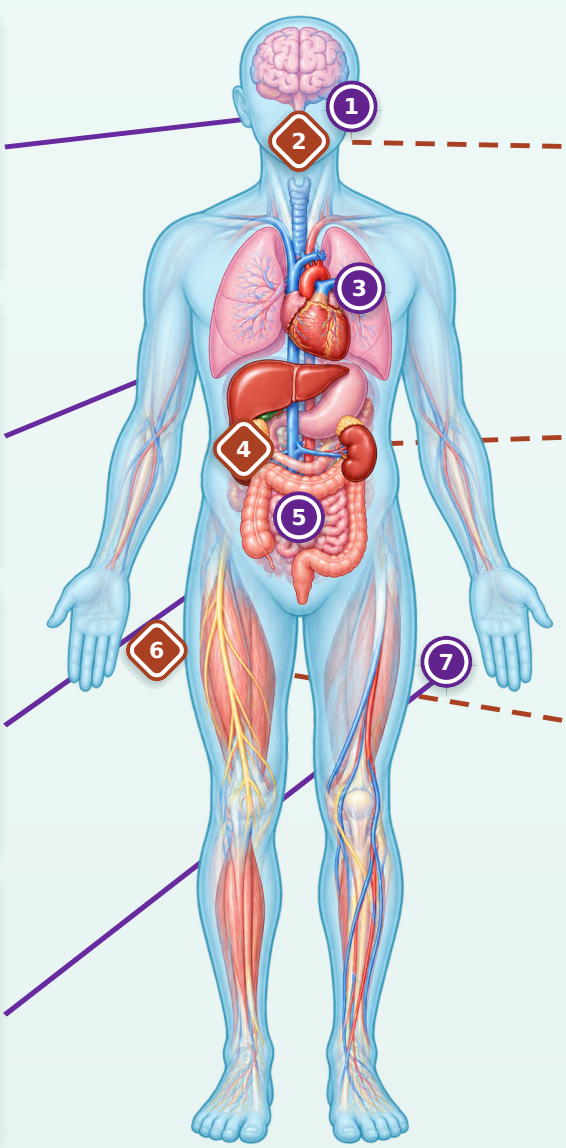
Both medicines

New breathlessness, wheeze or chest pain needs urgent assessment.

4 Kidneys / fluids

Cisplatin

Report reduced urine or inability to drink; kidney tests guide treatment.



5 Stomach / bowel

Both medicines

Use prescribed anti-sickness medicines; severe vomiting or diarrhoea needs advice.

6 Hands / feet

Cisplatin

Report numbness, tingling or problems with buttons, balance or walking.

7 Skin / blood counts

Both medicines

Report rash, unusual bruising or bleeding. Fever or sudden illness needs urgent advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Etoposide

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Hair loss and mouth soreness
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Effects on fertility and harm to an unborn baby
- Diarrhoea and liver-test changes
- Low blood pressure during infusion
- A later blood cancer (leukaemia)

Cisplatin

- Low blood counts, infection and bleeding
- Nausea, vomiting and fatigue
- Hair loss and mouth soreness
- Allergic or infusion reactions
- Effects on fertility and harm to an unborn baby
- Kidney injury and electrolyte loss
- Hearing changes or tinnitus, which may persist
- Nerve symptoms, which may persist

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Preventing sickness across all treatment days

Take the written anti-sickness plan even if you feel well. The plan must cover the risk of the medicines on each of Days 1–3 and the two days after the last treatment. Ask the pharmacist to show which medicines are scheduled and which are rescue medicines.

One clear steroid plan

The anti-sickness plan may include dexamethasone. Follow the prescribed day-by-day instructions; do not add an extra steroid course or extend it yourself. Tell the team about diabetes, poor sleep or mood changes.

Fluids and kidney protection

Cisplatin needs IV fluid before and after treatment and may need magnesium/potassium replacement. Your team adapts this for your kidneys, heart and fluid balance. Ask for a personal drinking plan and call if you cannot drink or pass much urine.

If etoposide capsules are prescribed

The source alternative uses capsules on an empty stomach twice daily on Days 2 and 3. Your pharmacy label gives your individual capsule dose. Do not substitute capsules for an infusion yourself, crush/open capsules, double a missed dose or repeat a vomited dose without advice. Obtain safe handling and storage instructions.

Medicines, mouth care and infection advice

Check prescriptions, painkillers, supplements and vaccines with the oncology team. Some medicines affect kidney/hearing toxicity or etoposide exposure. Follow mouth-care advice and keep the unit’s urgent contact instructions available.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital’s instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00280/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.